

ble by 4, the most significant group SHALL contain less than 4 nibbles and any lesser significant groups SHALL contain 4 nibbles.

Examples of valid hexadecimal groups separated by an underscore:

- "0xAA_33CC"
- "0x1234_ABCD"
- "0x1234_ABCD_526E_6242"

Binary numbers are specified as successive groups of bits, and SHALL be separated by a space (" ") or underscore ("_") character at least every 4 bits from the most significant bit (next to the 0b prefix and leftmost on the page) to the least significant bit (rightmost on the page), e.g. the binary number 0b0000_1111 represents the decimal number 15 and hexadecimal 0x0F.

Where individual bits are indicated (e.g. bit 3) the bit numbers are relative to the least significant bit which is bit 0.

When a digit is specified as having any value in the range of that digit, it is specified with an "x" (this should not be confused with the "x" in the prefix "0x" for hexadecimal notation).

For example:

- "0b0000_0xxx" indicates that the lower 3 bits can take any value but the upper 5 bits must each be set to 0.
- "0x0000_0xxx" indicates that the lower 3 nibbles can take any value but the upper 5 nibbles must each be set to 0.

Bit ranges are always indicated starting with the most significant bit number. Therefore bits 7..4 are equivalent to the mask 0b1111_0000 or 0xF0.

1.8.4. Provisional

Per [Alliance-PNP], when a specification is completed there may be sections of specification text (or smaller pieces of a section) that are not certifiable at this stage. These sections (or smaller pieces of a section) are marked as provisional prior to publishing the specification. This specification uses well-defined notation to mark **Provisional Conformance** or notes a section of text with the term "provisional".